

PITTSBURGH STEELERS

INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — Mike Tomlin is gone, Mike McCarthy is in, and Aaron Rodgers has announced this will be the last season of his career.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

Mike McCarthy

NEW HEAD COACH

22nd

RODGERS' FINAL SEASON

42

RODGERS' AGE

T.J. Watt

CONTRACT STANDOFF

5.8

RODGERS' AIR YARDS/ATT
(2025)

FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **The end of the Tomlin era.** Pittsburgh is in the middle of one of the most significant transitions in franchise history: **Mike McCarthy** officially takes over following Mike Tomlin's departure.
- ◆ **McCarthy and Rodgers, reunited.** The two last worked together in Green Bay in 2017. McCarthy has told reporters Rodgers still has **"otherworldly arm strength"** — while the numbers show a career-low **5.8 air yards per attempt** in 2025.
- ◆ **Nothing was left alone.** Pittsburgh touched virtually every position group this offseason after another one-and-done postseason — bold trades, targeted free agency, and a clear draft priority.
- ◆ **The defense is the storyline** that the sweeping changes were built around.

TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **SIGNED** **Jamel Dean, CB** — three years, \$36.75M from Tampa Bay. He allowed a league-best **4.7 yards per target** among outside corners in 2025.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **S Jaquan Brisker** (1 yr / \$5.5M, from Chicago, all 17 starts last season), **S Darnell Savage**, and **DT Sebastian Joseph-Day** — a defensive back seven rebuilt in one wave.
- ◆ **Offensive weapons in place:** WRs **DK Metcalf** and **Michael Pittman Jr.**, with a bruising backfield of **Jaylen Warren** and **Rico Dowdle** — the supporting cast assembled for Rodgers' last ride.
- ◆ **DRAFT** QB **Drew Allar** in the third round (four-year rookie deal signed) and QB **Will Howard** in the sixth — the succession plan starts now.
- ◆ **ROSTER** **Mason Rudolph** remains on the roster, though how much longer is a fair question with two drafted quarterbacks in the room.

RUMOR MILL

- ◆ **SPECULATION** National voices have floated a **T.J. Watt trade** as part of a broader Steelers reset. There is no reported trade — but the contract friction underneath the chatter is real.

PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **CONTRACT** **T.J. Watt, EDGE.** Negotiations have not produced a new deal, and tension has grown into camp. Watt and **Cam Heyward** both missed practices or worked on their own this offseason while seeking more money.
- ◆ **How Watt is used.** Pittsburgh may move him around more in 2026 to manufacture one-on-one matchups and reduce how often he's chipped.
- ◆ **Aaron Rodgers, QB.** Season 22, and he has said it is his last. At 42 he is a different player than the one McCarthy coached — the offense will be built to hide that.
- ◆ **DK Metcalf & Michael Pittman Jr., WR.** The best receiver pairing Rodgers has had in years.
- ◆ **Warren & Dowdle, RB.** A deliberately physical backfield, designed to keep the passing game off schedule-neutral downs.
- ◆ **Drew Allar, QB.** The third-rounder is the actual future; how much he shows in camp matters more than the depth chart says.

LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Mike McCarthy	Hired as head coach after Tomlin's departure
▲ Jamel Dean, CB	3 yr / \$36.75M from Tampa Bay
▲ Jaquan Brisker, S	1 yr / \$5.5M from Chicago
▲ Darnell Savage, S	Free-agent signing
▲ Sebastian Joseph-Day, DT	Free-agent signing
▲ Drew Allar, QB	Third-round pick, four-year rookie deal
▲ Will Howard, QB	Sixth-round pick
▼ Mike Tomlin	Departed as head coach

THE BOTTOM LINE

Pittsburgh replaced the second-longest-tenured coach in football, handed the job to the man who coached its 42-year-old quarterback a decade ago, and spent the offseason buying that quarterback the best supporting cast he has had since Green Bay. **Rodgers says this is the end**, which turns 2026 into a single-elimination season for everyone involved. The unresolved item is the best defensive player in the building: T.J. Watt wants paid, and camp starts anyway.